Behavioural Psychology

Individual Reflective Assignments — Course: 21GNH401TA

Course:	21GNH401TA Behavioral Psychology
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Assignment 1: Understanding Yourself for Effectiveness

Based on Unit 1 – Understanding Self for Effectiveness

Q1. Positive vs. Negative Self-Concept

Based on Self-Concept

Positive: I am patient when teaching or explaining things to others. I have a strong eye for visual detail. I am adaptable in unfamiliar cities and environments. I am practical when solving problems. I am reliable in group tasks. I am respectful of other people's boundaries. I am curious about how machines and software interact. I stay level-headed when plans change suddenly. I am thoughtful with my words. I am persistent once I commit to a goal.

Negative: I second-guess my decisions even after making them. I avoid speaking up in large classrooms because I assume my point isn't important enough. I let small mistakes ruin my mood for the entire evening.

Reflection: Writing the negative statements felt almost automatic, whereas the positive ones required me to pause and verify if I truly deserved to claim them. In daily life, my internal voice notices my hesitation far more than my competence. Recognising this imbalance shows me that I judge myself by my doubts rather than my actual actions.

Q2. Self-Concept Circle

Based on Self-Concept

Body: I have decent stamina and enjoy long evening walks or playing badminton, though late-night screen habits often leave me feeling sluggish in the mornings. I rarely pay attention to my posture or physical fatigue until my body forces me to rest. Personality: I am observant, calm on the surface, and prefer meaningful one-on-one conversations over loud group banter. However, I can become overly guarded when I feel judged. Abilities: I am good at debugging code, organising workflows, and noticing patterns through photography. On the other hand, I struggle with impromptu speaking and pitching ideas on the spot.

Role in family: I am the only child, which means I carry both my parents' complete trust and the quiet weight of being their sole expectation. I try to be self-sufficient so they don't have to worry about me from afar. Hardest section: The 'Role in family' section was the hardest to write because putting that mix of gratitude and pressure into two sentences made me realise how much of my ambition is tied to keeping my parents secure.

Q3. Twenty Statements Test — Who Am I?

Based on Self-Concept

1. I am an engineering undergraduate. (Social)
2. I am someone who notices small visual details. (Psychological)
3. I am a son who calls home every evening. (Social)
4. I am a hobbyist photographer. (Social)
5. I am a person who dislikes unnecessary conflict. (Psychological)
6. I am someone who wears glasses. (Physical)
7. I am cautious before trusting new people. (Psychological)
8. I am a badminton player on weekends. (Social)
9. I am slightly lean in build. (Physical)
10. I am someone trying to become more decisive. (Psychological)

Reflection: My statements are distributed across the categories as follows: Psychological (4), Social (4), Physical (2). This suggests that I currently see myself through a combination of my relationships, inner qualities, and physical identity rather than through only one aspect.

Q4. The Wheel of Emotions

Based on Understanding Emotions

When I boarded the train leaving home after the semester break, I felt a complicated, heavy mix of emotions that lingered for hours. The five core emotions blended together were: gratitude (for the quiet comfort of home-cooked meals and family time), guilt (seeing my parents stand on the platform looking slightly older than last year), anticipation (looking forward to meeting my college friends and starting new subjects), restlessness (wanting the long journey to be over), and apprehension (worrying about the heavier academic workload ahead).

What triggered it: Watching my mother wave from the platform as the train pulled out. It made the transition between two completely different lives feel sudden and sharp.

Q5. The Feeling Wheel — Naming My Emotions

Based on Understanding Emotions

Last week during a coding lab evaluation, I felt distinctly indignant and overlooked — not just 'annoyed' or 'upset.' I had written a clean, original script for the problem, but the evaluator barely glanced at my logic and gave me the exact same average mark as someone who had copied a template with errors.

What triggered it: The feeling that genuine effort and honesty were invisible in a rushed grading process.

How I responded: Instead of arguing aggressively or staying completely silent, I waited until the rush around the desk cleared and politely asked the teaching assistant to look at my optimisation function. He actually noticed the difference and updated my score. Naming the feeling as 'overlooked' helped me ask for fairness calmly.

Q6. Reframing a Challenge Optimistically

Based on Optimism

Challenge: My team's prototype failed to initialize during the first round of a department hackathon after we had worked on it for fourteen hours straight.

Initial feeling: 'We wasted the entire weekend for nothing. Every other team has a working demo and we look incompetent. I always freeze up when hardware and software integration goes wrong under a timer.'

Optimistic reframe: 'One failed demo in a 24-hour hackathon doesn't erase what we learned

building it. The bug happened because we rushed the serial port testing at the end — a specific technical step we can fix next time. We now have a nearly complete project we can refine for our mini-project exhibition next month.'

What changed: My initial reaction treated the setback as permanent and personal ('we look incompetent', 'always'). The optimistic version isolated the exact cause of the failure and saw the effort as reusable progress rather than wasted time.

Q7. My Optimism Test Result

Based on Optimism

I completed the Optimism Test on PsychologyToday.com and scored in the 'moderately realistic / slightly cautious' range. This matches my personality closely: I rarely expect things to go magically well on their own, so I over-prepare for worst-case scenarios. While this defensive caution helps me catch mistakes early in technical work, it also means that when a setback happens, I am too quick to say 'I knew this wouldn't work.' I need to separate practical preparation from expecting defeat so that I don't drain my own enthusiasm before starting.

Q8. Why Self-Awareness Matters to Me

Based on Self-Awareness

For me, self-awareness acts like a mirror that stops me from projecting my own stress onto other people. When I understand why I am reacting a certain way, I have a choice in how I behave instead of running on autopilot. Real example: A few months ago, I noticed I was getting irritated whenever my friend talked about his internship preparation. At first, I told myself he was bragging. When I paused and looked at my reaction honestly, I realised he wasn't bragging at all — I was just anxious because I hadn't updated my own resume yet. Recognising my own insecurity saved me from acting cold toward a good friend and pushed me to sit down and start my own preparation.

Q9. My Johari Window

Based on Self-Awareness

Open (known to me and others): I am methodical and prefer having a clear plan before starting any trip or assignment. Both my friends and I know I am the one who checks schedules and details twice. Hidden (known to me, not to others): I often replay minor awkward conversations in my head for days afterward, worrying that I said the wrong thing, even though I appear completely unbothered on the outside. Blind Spot (noticed by others, not fully by me): A project partner recently told me that when I am concentrating deeply on a screen, I frown so intensely that people think I am angry with them and hesitate to approach me.

Q10. My Self-Esteem Tree

Based on Self-Esteem

Roots: My parents' quiet sacrifices, my cultural upbringing that values humility and learning, and my belief that integrity matters even when nobody is watching.

Trunk: Patience, visual creativity, analytical debugging, and dependability.

Branches: Engineering student, son, friend, campus photographer, roommate.

Leaves: Building my first working web application from scratch, having two of my photographs selected for the college magazine, and managing my own finances responsibly this semester.

Fruits: Becoming a skilled software systems engineer, travelling with my camera to document stories across India, and giving my parents a comfortable, worry-free retirement.

Reflection: I am proudest of my trunk — specifically my patience and dependability. In an

environment where everyone is rushing for quick shortcuts, knowing that I can sit with a difficult problem calmly and be someone my friends can count on gives me genuine self-respect.

Assignment 2: Thinking, Problem-Solving & Life Skills

Based on Unit 2 (Problem Solving & Creativity) and Unit 3 (Life Skills)

Q1. Opening My Mind

Based on Thinking

Because I enjoy photography, communicating only through images sounds fascinating at first, as emotions like joy or loneliness can be captured in a single frame. However, daily life in engineering lectures would become chaotic — explaining conditional logic, deadlines, or why a piece of code failed without words would take ten times longer. Even with family, reassuring my parents that I am eating well and studying properly would lack precision. What this showed me: Images are powerful for capturing mood and atmosphere, but my analytical thinking relies entirely on structured verbal language to connect cause and effect.

Q2. Thinking About My Thinking

Based on Thinking

Last five things I thought about today:

1. How to fix the alignment bug in my project UI — Future/Present, myself.
2. Whether my mother remembered to renew her medicine prescription — Present, someone else.
3. A remark a classmate made during morning attendance — Past, someone else.
4. How much money is left in my UPI wallet for the rest of the month — Future, myself.
5. Whether I should go for badminton this evening or finish my record work — Future, myself.

Pattern: Almost all my thoughts revolve around practical maintenance — fixing bugs, managing budgets, checking on family, and balancing schedules. I spend very little time daydreaming; my mind is constantly running a checklist, which keeps me organised but also mentally tired.

Q3. Fast vs. Slow Thinking in My Life

Based on Thinking

Fast thinking decisions:

1. Ordered an expensive electronics accessory online during a flash sale countdown — realised later I barely needed it.
2. Deleted a local code branch thinking it was already merged — lost three hours of unbacked work.
3. Said 'I'm fine with anything' when choosing a project topic — got stuck working on a domain I found dull.

Slow thinking decisions:

1. Compared three different certification courses over a weekend before enrolling — chose one with hands-on labs that actually helped me.
2. Drafted and re-read an email to my faculty advisor about an attendance clash — got approval without any misunderstanding.
3. Set a monthly spending limit at the start of the semester — avoided borrowing money at the end of the month. Slow thinking produced better outcomes every single time. My fast decisions were driven either by artificial urgency or by wanting to avoid friction in the moment, both of which cost me time and money later.

Q4. Reverse Thinking – Flip It Around

Based on Reverse Thinking

To completely ruin my time management and become the worst listener in class:

1. Keep ten browser tabs open while trying to finish an assignment → Close all unrelated tabs and work in single-task blocks.

2. Leave my earphones on one ear during lectures → Put earphones inside my bag before the professor enters.

3. Assume a lecture slide is easy and stop paying attention → Write down one practical question or example for every topic covered.

4. Say yes to late-night gaming or tea outings right before an 8 AM class → Set a hard 11:30 PM cutoff on weeknights.

5. Judge a speaker's accent or delivery style instead of their content → Focus strictly on the core concept being explained.

6. Wait for motivation to strike before opening my books → Follow a 10-minute starter rule regardless of mood. Insight: Flipping my worst tendencies made me see how subtle distractions — like keeping one earphone in or leaving extra tabs open — quietly sabotage both my listening and my study hours. Identify an unhelpful habit Flip it into a positive action Practise the action regularly Review and adjust progress Fig. 2.1: Reverse-thinking process

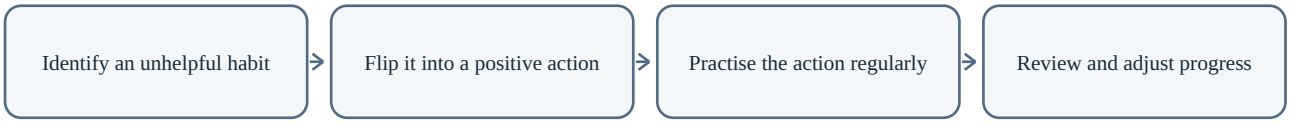


Fig. 2.1: Reverse-thinking process

Q5. My Personal SWOT

Based on Problem Solving Techniques (SWOT)

Area: Communication Skills

Strengths: I listen carefully without interrupting. I write clear, well-structured emails and documentation. In one-on-one settings, people find me approachable and calm.

Weaknesses: I hesitate to speak first in large group discussions. My voice tends to drop in volume when I feel nervous on stage. I sometimes over-explain technical details instead of summarising the main point.

Opportunities: Volunteering to present the demo segment in class mini-projects. Joining campus club debriefs to practice speaking in mid-sized groups. Recording a two-minute rehearsal on my phone before formal viva exams.

Threats: Dominant speakers in group discussions easily talk over quieter members. High-pressure viva environments trigger my self-consciousness. Relying too much on text messaging reduces real- time verbal practice.

Q6. Active Listening in Practice

Based on Communication

I called my cousin who recently started his first job in Bengaluru and asked him to talk about his week for two minutes without me interrupting. He spoke about the exhausting two-hour traffic commute, feeling out of place in corporate meetings where everyone uses jargon, and the small relief of cooking dinner for himself on Sunday night. Summary: He is finding the transition from college to corporate life

overwhelming, especially the daily commute and workplace pressure, though small routines in his apartment give him a sense of stability.

Reflection: Because it was a phone call, the hardest part was not filling the brief pauses with 'haan, don't worry' or comparing his routine to my college schedule. Staying quiet during his pauses actually made him open up more honestly about feeling lonely in a new city.

Q7. The Floor Is Yours

Based on Communication (On-the-Spot Activities)

Prompt chosen: (b) My own life goal, explained to someone who has never met me. 'If we haven't met before, the simplest way to understand what drives me is that I like making complex things feel simple and human. A lot of digital tools today are built for people who are already tech-savvy, while ordinary users — like older parents or small shop owners — feel intimidated by cluttered interfaces. My life goal is to grow into a software engineer and designer who builds clean, accessible systems that never make the user feel foolish.Alongside my career, I want to keep documenting everyday life through photography, because both photography and good engineering require the same habit: paying close attention to people others overlook.'

Q8. Stepping Into Empathy

Based on Empathy

Two weeks ago during a heavy afternoon downpour, a food delivery rider arrived at our hostel gate completely soaked because his raincoat zip had broken, and he was apologising repeatedly because the paper bag had torn slightly at the corner. While a few students around the gate were complaining about delays, I looked at his shivering hands trying to wipe his phone screen so the app would register the delivery. What I noticed: He looked genuinely afraid that I would report him or give a one-star rating that would cut his daily incentive. How it made me feel: I felt a sudden wave of discomfort at how easily we treat human beings like app notifications. I imagined my own father standing in the rain apologising to someone half his age over a damp paper bag. Did it change how I acted? Yes. I told him immediately that the food was completely fine, handed him a dry towel from my bag and a bottle of warm water, and tipped him on the app with a five-star rating. It reminded me that empathy matters most when there is a power imbalance.

Q9. Treating Others Respectfully

Based on Respect

1. My father: I show respect by listening to his guidance and keeping him updated about my studies and plans. I try to consider his perspective before making important decisions.
2. My mother: I show respect by calling home regularly, asking about her day, and giving her concerns my full attention. I sometimes respond hurriedly after a tiring day, and I want to improve that.
3. My teacher: I show respect by arriving prepared, listening carefully, and discussing doubts politely. I also try to respect the time and effort teachers put into helping students.

Honest evaluation: I try to practise these habits consistently, but I need to be more patient during calls with my parents and more proactive about seeking feedback from teachers.

Q10. Building It Back Up – Resilience

Based on Resilience

Last year, I spent nearly a month curating and editing a portfolio of street and campus photographs to apply for the lead position in the college media club. During the final interview, the senior panel told me my technical framing was good, but they selected someone else who had more video-editing

experience. Walking out of that room felt like weeks of quiet hope collapsing at once.

How I responded: For a few days, I didn't touch my camera at all and felt like packing it away. Then a friend asked me to shoot candid photos for a small department workshop just for fun, with zero competition involved. What helped: Shooting that small event reminded me that I loved photography itself, not just a club title. I started learning basic video colour-grading on my own over the next month. Resilience for me meant separating the craft I loved from a single rejection.

Assignment 3: Stress, Personality & Socialization

Based on Unit 4 (Stress & Coping) and Unit 5 (Personality, Socialization & Human Values)

Q1. Sorting My Stress

Based on Stress Identification

Controllable (My Choices & Actions) Uncontrollable (Outside My Control)

1. Delaying my exam revision because I spend too much time tweaking minor design details in my lab projects.

1. Back-to-back timetable hours from 8:00 AM to 4:50 PM on Tuesdays and Thursdays with barely any break.

2. Drinking too much tea and using my laptop in bed past midnight, which leaves me exhausted the next morning.

2. Rising travel fares and limited direct train tickets back home during semester holidays.

3. Hesitating to ask doubts immediately during lectures and letting confusion pile up until cycle tests.

3. Sudden changes in syllabus evaluation rubrics announced mid-semester by the department.

Reflection: Putting this on paper shows me that while I cannot change the college timetable or train availability, fixing my sleep cutoff and asking questions in class would immediately cut my daily stress in half.

Q2. Recognising My Own Stress Symptoms

Based on Causes & Symptoms of Stress

Physical: Under high stress, I unconsciously clench my jaw while working and develop eye strain and a stiff neck that makes it uncomfortable to turn my head by evening.

Emotional: I feel a flat, heavy sense of overwhelm — where even small requests from friends feel like one task too many, accompanied by a quiet fear of disappointing people.

Cognitive: I experience mental tunnel vision and indecisiveness. Last week before two consecutive tests, I spent twenty minutes staring at my desk unable to decide which subject notebook to open first.

Behavioural: I start isolating myself by eating meals alone with my phone, checking my to-do list repeatedly without crossing anything off, and cleaning my desk obsessively to avoid starting difficult chapters.

Q3. The 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Exercise

Based on Grounding Exercise

I tried this exercise sitting near the library corridor window between two afternoon classes today: 5 things I can see: My black camera strap peeking out of my backpack, the scratched laminate surface of the reading table, sunlight reflecting off a parked bicycle outside, a blue notice pinned to the department board, and the dust motes floating in a beam of window light. 4 things I can touch: The textured rubber grip of my pen, the cool glass of my spectacles, the slightly warm wrist-rest of my laptop, and the rough denim of my jeans. 3 things I can hear: The quiet whir of the air conditioner overhead, footsteps echoing down the tiled corridor, and pages flipping at the next table. 2 things I can smell: The dry, papery smell of old library books and the faint lemon scent of floor cleaner. 1 thing I can taste: The mild mint flavour left from chewing gum after lunch.

Reflection: Doing this actually unclenched my jaw. Because I am a visual person, deliberately noticing five things I could see and four textures I could feel pulled my attention out of my afternoon fatigue and made me feel noticeably calmer and more alert.

Q4. Nature Journaling

Based on Nature Journaling

I walked over to the quiet stretch near the campus lake and banyan trees at 6:30 AM without earphones. The air felt cool and slightly humid against my skin, smelling of wet grass and morning mist. I watched the aerial roots of the banyan swaying barely an inch in the breeze while pond herons stood completely still at the water's edge waiting for ripples. Above the trees, the sky was turning from pale grey to soft gold, and the only sounds were chirping bulbuls and the distant sweep of a broom on the pathway.

Reflection: Ten minutes of observing nature without trying to photograph it or check notifications changed my mood more than I expected. It gave my eyes a rest from glowing rectangles and reminded me how peaceful mornings feel when I don't start the day rushing.

Q5. My Go-To Coping Strategy

Based on Strategies of Stress Management

When stress builds up, my go-to coping strategy is taking my camera (or just my phone) for a slow thirty-minute walk around campus in the evening, or playing a couple of intense sets of badminton at the court. Both combine physical movement with shifting my visual focus away from my study desk.

Honest evaluation: Walking and badminton genuinely work for me because they release physical tension and let my subconscious mind untangle problems quietly. However, on nights when I am too tired to go outside, I fall into scrolling through tech reviews and reels for hours, which is definitely a temporary escape that leaves my eyes tired and my stress unresolved. Notice stress signals Pause and identify the cause Choose a healthy coping action Reflect, recover and reset Fig. 3.1: Healthy coping sequence

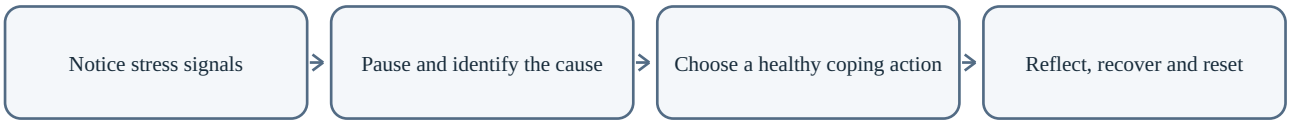


Fig. 3.1: Healthy coping sequence

Q6. My Big Five Personality Profile

Based on The Big Five Personality Test

I took the assessment on bigfive-test.com and my scores were: Openness: High (90/120), Conscientiousness: High (84/120), Extraversion: Moderate-Low (54/120), Agreeableness: Moderate-High (83/120), and Neuroticism: Moderate (72/120).

Reflection: These scores accurately capture how I operate. My highest score being Openness aligns with my love for photography, design, and exploring how systems work, while high Conscientiousness reflects my habit of planning schedules and double-checking details. My lower Extraversion and moderate Neuroticism also make sense — I enjoy deep conversations with a few close friends rather than big crowds, and I tend to internalise worry by second-guessing myself.

Q7. My Personality Type in Action

Based on Types of Personality (ABCD / MBTI)

Trait chosen: High Openness to Experience (paired with Introverted Observation). This trait shows up most clearly when I travel or visit a new place with friends. Last semester, when four of us went on a weekend trip to Pondicherry, my friends wanted to stick strictly to the three famous cafés they had seen on Instagram. Meanwhile, I ended up spending an hour wandering down a quiet side

street talking to an old bookbinder and photographing the Tamil-French courtyard architecture. Even in academics, high Openness makes me want to understand the 'why' behind an algorithm rather than just memorising steps for the exam. It keeps life interesting, though I sometimes have to remind myself to finish routine syllabus work before chasing a new curiosity.

Q8. Learning the Unwritten Rules

Based on Socialization Simulation

Moving from my hometown in the East to a large university campus in Chennai was my biggest socialization shift. In the first few weeks, I had to decode several unwritten rules: how students use a mix of English and local phrases to bond, how group seating in labs solidifies silently by week two, and that calling seniors 'bro' or 'anna/akka' sets a much warmer tone than being overly stiff and formal. How I adapted: At first, I was self-conscious about my accent and stayed quiet. I adapted by learning a few basic Tamil greetings, sharing food from home with my floor-mates, and offering to take good portrait photos for people at club events. I stayed true to myself by not forcing a loud fake persona — I let people get to know me at my own steady pace.

Q9. A Different Perspective

Based on Embracing Diversity

My roommate this year grew up in a joint agricultural family in interior Tamil Nadu, whereas I grew up in an urban nuclear family in Assam/Bengal. One Sunday night, while sharing homemade snacks our parents had sent, we ended up talking for two hours about our upbringing, food habits, and festivals like Bihu and Pongal. What I learned: Despite the thousands of kilometres between our hometowns, I learned that both Bihu and Pongal celebrate the exact same seasonal gratitude toward harvest, cattle, and nature in mid-January. At the same time, hearing him describe how decisions in his village involve twenty extended relatives gave me a completely new appreciation for collective responsibility, compared to